

DETM - EN v2

DETM Book (EN v2)

mode: print

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Where to start (short hook)

Imagine a bridge.

From the outside, everything looks healthy: traffic flows, dashboards are green, reports look convincing. But bridges do not stand on reports. They stand on load limits, joints, maintenance windows, and the honesty of stress signals.

Human systems fail the same way. Usually not because nobody "wants good results", but because the system quietly learns that imitation is cheaper than reality:

- language still sounds correct while causality is already broken,
- metrics keep improving while field outcomes degrade,
- institutions defend capture instead of resilience,

- the old regime passes its boundary and no longer converges.

This book is not a moral lecture and not a motivational script. It is an operational diagnostic guide:

1. identify the active failure level,
2. apply the smallest operator that restores causality,
3. move from emergency stabilization to controlled adaptation.

Core claim:

| Most hard system conflicts are conflicts between levels of description.

One actor speaks L0 (basis), another speaks L1 (actions), another speaks L2 (stories), another speaks L3 (metrics and rules), and another speaks L4/L5 (institutions and boundaries). They can all be "right" locally and still produce collective failure globally.

Levels map (L0..L5)

The model uses six operational levels.

Level	Question	Typical failure	Typical operator
L0	Does the system still hold?	basis collapse, fake participation	stop, exit, load reduction
L1	Do actions produce verified effects?	activity without effect	minimal action + readout
L2	Which stories/roles gate behavior?	rationalization, taboo, shame loops	reframe + permission update
L3	Which metrics/rules define reality?	Goodhart, metric theater	axis policy, anti-capture checks
L4	Who can change rules legitimately?	institutional capture	governance reset, veto rights
L5	Where are the regime boundaries?	delayed transition, hard crash	transition protocol

Use this map as routing logic, not ideology.

Quickstart (10 minutes)

1) One-sentence summary

Systems tend to optimize what is cheapest to hold now, and fail where regime-holding cost stops converging.

2) 60-second model map

- L0: basis/existence (0/1)
- L1: action -> observable effect

- L2: narratives and role contracts
- L3: metrics/rules/axis policy
- L4: institutions and sanctioning power
- L5: boundaries and transitions

3) First move protocol

If "any option leads to the same failure": go depth-first (L3 -> L1 -> L0). If causality holds but choice is unclear: go breadth-first (usually L2/L3).

4) Starter symptoms

- Fires everywhere, overload: start L0-C1 (pause/stop)
- Metrics up, reality down: start L3-C6 (break metric game)
- No clear next step: start L1-C2 (minimal readout)
- Narrative deadlock: start L3-C7 (axis policy)

5) Fast navigation

Use Sx/Ty and Lx-Cn codes from appendix navigation to jump directly to the needed operator.

First aid protocol (when the system is melting)

Use this in emergency mode before deep analysis.

1. Freeze escalation (L0-C1): stop adding commitments.
2. Restore a truthful sensor (L0-C6/L1-C2): one observable that cannot be faked cheaply.
3. Remove impossible scope (L0-C4): reduce obligations to sustainable capacity.
4. Isolate toxic coupling (L0-C5): quarantine the failure amplifier.
5. Decide path:
 - if causality returns -> move to L1/L2 refinement,
 - if causality does not return -> execute transition logic (L5).

Rule:

| In emergency, survival of causality has priority over optimization of goals.

Thesis

This book is about how systems hold a regime, and at what price.

By "system" we mean any coordinated structure where action and consequence must stay linked: person, family, team, organization, institution, state. By "regime" we mean the currently active way of operating: action cadence, feedback quality, cost distribution, and boundary handling.

The practical thesis is strict:

1. Stability is not produced by good intentions. It is produced by convergent basis contracts.
2. Learning is not "loss goes down". Learning is invariant retention under perturbation.
3. Metrics are sensors, not truth.
4. Rules are cost architecture, not morality.
5. Institutional quality is anti-capture plus reversibility.
6. Boundary crossing without transition protocol creates systemic debt.

Another way to read it:

- if report quality is decoupled from pain/cost, systems train reward hacking;
- if stopping rights are taboo, error debt accumulates invisibly;
- if axis policy is implicit, metric wars replace control.

Pragmatic consequence:

- diagnose by level (L0..L5),
- act with the smallest operator that restores causality,
- validate by multi-signal readout, never by one KPI.

Reader map

Choose your route.

Practitioner route

Quickstart -> L0 -> L1 -> L3 -> L5 -> Appendix: Navigation

Use this route if you need immediate operational decisions.

Research route

Thesis -> L0..L5 -> Invariants and tests -> Case registry

Use this route for model building and hypothesis design.

Governance route

L3 -> L4 -> L5 -> Case registry

Use this route for institutional design, policy and anti-capture work.

How to read this book

This is a diagnostic and operator handbook.

Reading rules:

1. Start from observed symptoms, not from favorite theory.
2. Identify active level(s) first.

3. Apply one operator at a time.
4. Validate with readout panel (never one KPI).
5. Escalate to deeper level only if current level does not restore causality.

Terminology:

- Sx/Ty: scene/topic code (where the symptom appears)
- Lx-Cn: level/operator code (what to do next)

For implementation links, use:

- docs/eng/* for narrative
- docs/rus/ROADMAP.md for execution status
- runtime tests/artifacts for verification.

L0: Existence (0/1) as minimal invariant

L0 is the basis layer. It does not ask whether the system is efficient, elegant, or successful. It asks a harder question:

Can this system still keep action and consequence connected over the current horizon?

Operationally:

- $L_0 = 1$: basis contracts still hold (with recoverable default rate).
- $L_0 = 0$: basis defaults are systemic and causality degrades into noise.

Why L0 matters

When L0 collapses, upper layers become decorative:

- L1 becomes activity theater,
- L2 becomes rationalization,
- L3 becomes metric gaming,
- L4 becomes enforcement of drift,
- L5 arrives as forced transition instead of planned transition.

Typical L0 signals

- recurrent default on basic promises,
- imitation replacing real participation,
- chronic overload with no recovery windows,
- silent withdrawal from key actors,
- rising effort for shrinking stabilizing effect.

Core operators

- L0-C1: pause/stop to prevent nonlinear escalation,
- L0-C2: refusal/exit as truthful diagnostic signal,
- L0-C4: obligation reduction to sustainable capacity,

- L0-C5: quarantine of toxic coupling,
- L0-C6: restoration of feedback that cannot be faked cheaply.

Readout panel

- basis stability rate,
- basic-default frequency,
- participation authenticity,
- recovery-window integrity,
- intervention-energy / stabilization-gain ratio.

If L0 cannot be restored in bounded attempts, switch from optimization mode to L5 transition mode.

L1: Minimal operation and verified effect

L1 is the action layer.

Question:

| Which smallest action changes state in a measurable way?

Failure patterns

- high activity, zero state change,
- long loops with no truthful readout,
- parallelism overload and hidden queues,
- post-mortems that punish people instead of fixing operators.

Core operators

- L1-C1 minimum viable action,
- L1-C2 minimum truthful readout,
- L1-C3 cycle shortening,
- L1-C4 parallelism reduction,
- L1-C7 "done = verified".

Readout panel

- cycle time and variance,
- step success ratio,
- rework ratio,
- queue pressure.

L1 must stay connected to L0 constraints and L3 axis policy.

L2: Narratives, roles, and interpretation

L2 captures social semantics:

- what can be said,
- who may act,
- what is considered legitimate.

Typical failures

- blame theater replacing diagnosis,
- heroism normalized as default,
- taboo on stopping or dissent,
- explanation replacing experiment.

Core operators

- explicit reframe (L2-C5),
- permission repair (who is allowed to pause/report truth),
- anti-taboo probes (L2-C6),
- shift from story to test (L2-C7).

Readout

- quality of disagreement,
- ability to report bad news safely,
- ratio of experiments to explanations.

L2 is not optional: if roles forbid truth, L1/L3 degrade fast.

L3: Metrics, rules, and axis policy

L3 is the layer where systems decide what counts as reality.

If this choice is implicit, control degrades quickly. If this choice is explicit, L3 becomes a stabilizer.

Main risk:

| Goodhart mode: optimizing a sensor while degrading the underlying dynamics.

Typical failures

- dashboard growth with declining field outcomes,
- incentives that reward imitation over repair,
- obligation growth detached from real capacity,
- hidden transfer of error cost to lower layers,
- post-hoc metric redefinition to avoid accountability.

Core operators

- L3-C1: keep metric as sensor, never as standalone objective,
- L3-C4: enforce stop-rule guardrails,

- L3-C5: return error cost to source,
- L3-C6: break report theater and reconnect report to field reality,
- L3-C7: define axis policy explicitly (which projections govern decisions).

Readout panel

- target metric plus at least two independent counter-signals,
- escalation/refinement pressure over time,
- transferability and robustness under perturbation,
- mismatch rate between report claims and trace-level evidence.

L3 quality is measured by controllability, not by dashboard aesthetics.

L4: Institutions, power, and anti-capture

L4 asks:

| Who can change rules, and under which legitimacy constraints?

Failure patterns

- concentrated interpretation monopoly,
- blocked veto/stop rights,
- irreversible decisions without rollback path,
- governance serving capture rather than system resilience.

Core operators

- distributed veto/stop rights,
- explicit rollback protocols,
- periodic legitimacy audits,
- anti-capture governance checks.

Readout

- reversibility index,
- authority concentration indicators,
- response time to confirmed systemic defects.

L4 quality determines whether L3 corrections are possible in practice.

L5: Boundaries, transitions, and regime change

L5 handles boundaries where old optimization stops converging.

Typical signs

- repeated L0/L1 restoration attempts fail,

- growing intervention energy for shrinking effect,
- stable mismatch between reported and observed reality,
- structural debt accumulates faster than remediation.

Core operators

- transition trigger criteria,
- controlled shutdown or scope contraction,
- contract renegotiation before restart,
- post-transition invariant validation.

Readout

- transition success under fixed horizon,
- debt reduction trajectory,
- restored causality and participation quality.

At L5, the question is not "optimize more", but "change regime safely".

Terms

- **Basis (L0):** minimal contracts/resources that keep causality alive.
- **Readout:** multi-signal observation panel used for decision validation.
- **Goodhart mode:** optimization of a sensor that degrades real dynamics.
- **Axis policy:** explicit choice of which projections/metrics define reality.
- **Capture:** concentration of interpretation/rule power in one actor/group.
- **Transition:** explicit regime shift when current mode no longer converges.
- **Invariant:** retained class/property under perturbation.
- **Operator:** minimal action that changes state in a verifiable way.

Case registry (compact)

Use this table as an entry point.

Symptom	First code	Typical follow-up
overload, fire mode	L0-C1	L0-C4, L1-C2
fake progress	L3-C6	L3-C7, L1-C2
no next step	L1-C2	L1-C1, L2-C7
role conflict	L2-C5	L3-C7, L4 checks
capture suspicion	L4 audit	L3-C7, L5 transition criteria

Extend this registry with domain-specific scenarios.

Navigation cheat sheet (S-T-C)

Scenes

- S1: person
- S2: family/close network
- S3: society/game layer
- S4: organization
- S5: state/institutions

Topics

- T1: pause/stop
- T2: refusal/exit
- T3: heroic overuse
- T4: obligation reduction
- T5: quarantine
- T6: feedback restoration
- T7: interpretation/axis control

Operator map

- L0: L0-C1..C7 (existence operators)
- L1: L1-C1..C7 (action/readout operators)
- L2: L2-C1..C7 (narrative/role operators)
- L3: L3-C1..C7 (metric/rule operators)

Search tips:

- combine scene + topic (S4/T6),
- or jump directly by operator code (L3-C7).

Invariants and tests

This checklist aligns book-level diagnostics with repo-level verification.

Invariants

1. Causality can be measured (no blind optimization).
2. Readout is multi-signal (anti-Goodhart).
3. Basis stress is visible before collapse.
4. Rule changes preserve rollback path.
5. Transition criteria are explicit before regime switch.

Practical tests

- reproducible headless runs (catalog/metrics/summary/final_state),
- trace/watch linkage (trace_ref continuity),
- metric-countermetric consistency,
- no hidden dependency from core (detm/*) to app UI.

For current execution status, see docs/rus/ROADMAP.md.

Index (keywords)

- anti-capture
- anti-goodhart
- axis policy
- basis / L0
- boundary / transition
- causality
- default rate
- invariant
- metric theater
- operator
- readout panel
- regime change
- rollback
- scope reduction
- transition protocol

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